

Let's get walking

Before it was known as Autodesk MotionBuilder, it was called Filmbox. Kaydara, the company behind Filmbox built the software from ground up with the hope of revolutionising the animation industry. Filmbox was quite advanced and honestly, way ahead of its time. After its acquisition by Autodesk, it was met with a challenge. How does MotionBuilder remain relevant within a company such as Autodesk when there's also Maya to contend with? Over the years, the two software have grown apart and have specialised use cases. The choice between the two boils down to a few simple things.

The first is the obvious one, familiarity. If you're familiar with either software, you'd want to stick with that. While the two software were quite competitive in the late '00s and early '10s, it's not the case anymore. Now, if you wish to work on animation which requires a lot of motion capture, then MotionBuilder should be your go to software since it is much better at ingesting MoCap data and putting it all together. Maya, on the other hand, is an industry standard where MoCap isn't involved. Several industry veterans have stated that MotionBuilder's strengths lie truly in its MoCap technology and MotionBuilder is best used in combination with Maya.

Today, you have Ikenema, who make powerful MoCap software that rivals MotionBuilder in quite a lot of aspects. They were good enough that Apple went ahead and acquired the company two years ago. Among the many industry giants that champion for MotionBuilder is James Cameron who used the software while making Avatar. It should be known that James Cameron put the Avatar script on ice for a long time because he didn't believe that the right tools existed for the job. So if James Cameron